

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1441

By Farmer

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Gary Odom Roach of Sevierville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Gary Odom Roach; and

WHEREAS, Gary Roach was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on December 8, 1949, to Ed and Teresa Roach, Mr. Roach was raised in Rutledge in a close-knit community that shaped his lifelong values of faith, service, and fellowship; and

WHEREAS, a 1967 graduate of Rutledge High School, Gary Roach furthered his education at East Tennessee State University, where he earned a Bachelor of Education degree in 1971, and at the University of Montevallo, Alabama, where he earned a Master of Educational Administration degree in 1974; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Roach devoted the majority of his professional life to the field of education, serving as a teacher in Grainger County; transportation supervisor and assistant principal in Hamblen County; assistant principal in Jefferson County; and, ultimately, principal of Sevier County High School, where he earned the distinction as the longest-serving principal in the school's history, with eighteen years of service; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure as principal, he provided visionary leadership that contributed to numerous academic and extracurricular achievements, including the establishment of the school's "Smoky Salutes" Veterans Day program and the Sevier County High School Alumni Association, and the school's first team state championships in football in 1999 and girls' basketball in 2002; and

WHEREAS, Gary Roach's professional excellence was recognized through numerous honors, including Tennessee Transportation Supervisor of the Year, TSSAA Regional Principal of the Year, and Tennessee Secondary Principal of the Year, and the City of Sevierville proclaimed April 30, 2009, as "Gary Roach Day" in honor of his retirement; and

WHEREAS, in 2023, he was inducted into the Sevier County Education Hall of Fame, further reflecting the enduring impact of his contributions to education and his community; and

WHEREAS, a man of deep and abiding faith, Mr. Roach was a devoted member of First Baptist Church Sevierville, where he served as a lifetime deacon and taught Sunday School for many years, sharing his wisdom and encouragement with generations of congregants; and

WHEREAS, he was also deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Gary Roach is survived by his beloved wife of nearly five decades, Darlene Roach; his daughters, Sally (Whit) Helton, Sandra Roach, Susan (Andy) Steele, and Sarah (Will) Allen; his grandchildren, Zachary Newsome, John Tate, Erin Tate, Preslee Cubberley, Hunter Allen, Abigale Allen, and Mason Manning; his sister-in-law, Glenda Roach, and her children, Willie, Candace, and Julia; his brother-in-law, Quentin Seals, and his daughter, Grant; and a host of extended family members and friends; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his parents, Ed and Teresa Roach, and his brother, Dennis Roach; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Roach leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Gary Odom Roach, reflecting fondly upon his

impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Roach.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.